Robert Leggett

Summary

I'm an experienced and collaborative technology leader with a strong engineering and architecture background and over eighteen years of experience in the Information Technology industry.

Known for building and leading high performing, diverse teams and fostering cultures of excellence, accountability, and innovation in government, manufacturing, identity, finance, telecommunication and AI industries with a focus on delivering exceptional outcomes and customer value.

Passionate about mentoring talent, enhancing customer outcomes and leading by example to drive digital, agile and culture transformation while excelling at aligning technology strategy with business goals, removing delivery blockers, and enabling teams to execute with autonomy and clarity.

Energised by complex challenges, senior stakeholder engagement, and environments where purpose-driven teams solve problems that matter.

Experiences

Principal Architect

Slater and Gordon Lawyers

2025 – Present

- A strategic and commercially focused leader responsible for defining and executing the enterprise technology strategy in alignment with business objectives, regulatory obligations, and long-term transformation goals.
- Leads the architecture vision across Cloud, Data, AI, Core Platforms, and Integration, ensuring scalable, secure, and sustainable solutions that support growth, efficiency, and improved client outcomes.
- Drives firm-wide transformation initiatives, translating complex business challenges into clear architectural options, roadmaps, and investment cases for executive and board-level decision-making.
- Provides architectural leadership across key platforms including Client Intake, Pricing, Legal Cost Agreements (LCAs), Case Management, and Digital Client Experience, ensuring consistency, interoperability, and reuse.
- Champions the responsible adoption of AI-enabled capabilities across the client lifecycle, balancing innovation with governance, risk, and compliance in a highly regulated legal environment.
- Establishes and governs architectural principles, standards, and target states to reduce complexity, manage technical debt, and optimise long-term cost and operational sustainability.
- Partners closely with the CIO, technology leaders, and senior business stakeholders to align architectural direction with strategic priorities, funding cycles, and measurable business outcomes.
- Guides legacy modernisation and platform decommissioning, minimising business disruption while accelerating transition to modern, modular, and AI-ready architectures.
- Acts as a trusted advisor to executives, providing clear insight into trade-offs, dependencies, delivery risk, and time-to-value.
- Embeds pragmatic architecture governance into delivery, enabling speed and agility without compromising quality, security, or compliance.
- Mentors and uplifts architectural capability across the organisation, fostering a strong, consistent, and future-focused practice.

Technical Contractor

Coles Group

2025

- A strategic and delivery-focused technology leader with deep expertise in building scalable enterprise platforms, orchestrating distributed systems, and aligning technical execution with business outcomes in highly regulated environments.
- Leads the design and delivery of distributed orchestration frameworks (Commander/Workers), ensuring resilient task execution, fan-out patterns, and secure result aggregation across PCI-sensitive workloads.
- Drives modern cloud infrastructure, DevOps, and automation strategies, optimising CI/CD pipelines, containerisation, and deployment to Azure for speed, security, and cost efficiency.
- Provides architectural leadership across microservices, APIs, messaging, and data integrations, delivering robust and maintainable codebases aligned to long-term strategy.
- Champions platform reliability and observability, implementing proactive monitoring, logging, and incident response to maintain uptime and compliance across mission-critical systems.
- Collaborates with Product and Engineering stakeholders to translate business requirements into actionable technical roadmaps, balancing innovation with stability in delivery.
- Fosters high-performing engineering teams through mentorship, knowledge-sharing, and a culture of continuous improvement across DevOps, Backend, and Platform functions.
- Balances innovation with governance by managing technical debt, PCI compliance boundaries, and secure development practices to protect customer data and meet audit requirements.
- Provides strategic oversight for engineering operations, vendor collaboration, and infrastructure investment, ensuring optimal return on technology initiatives.
- Committed to operational excellence, applying modern software engineering, security best practice, AI and cloud-native innovation to deliver sustainable growth and business value.

Head of Technology

TRU Recognition

2024 – 2025

- A visionary and results-driven technology leader with a proven track record in defining and executing technical roadmaps that align with business goals to drive scalability, security, and long-term sustainability.
- Deep expertise across cloud infrastructure, AI/ML, DevOps, API, and application integration domains.
- Leads high-performing engineering and infrastructure teams across Platform, Product Engineering, DevOps, and AI/ML, cultivating a culture of innovation, accountability, and continuous improvement.
- Passionate about talent development, mentorship, and building scalable, empowered organisations equipped for future challenges.
- Drives modern cloud-native engineering practices, including CI/CD automation, secure and reliable infrastructure design, AI/ML model deployment, performance optimisation, and cost-efficient operations.
- Balances technical innovation with effective management of technical debt to ensure long-term maintainability and reliability.
- Provides strategic oversight of engineering and infrastructure programs — including scope, time, cost, people, and vendor management — aligning execution with enterprise priorities to maximise technology ROI.
- Partners closely with Product and Executive Leadership to synchronise delivery roadmaps, release cycles, and operational workflows.
- Champion of operational excellence, leveraging automation, observability, and modern tooling to ensure service health, system reliability, and responsive incident management.
- Actively shapes and communicates strategy, values, and priorities to secure buy-in across varied stakeholders and create clear, actionable technology roadmaps.
- Engages across the enterprise and broader technology community to share operational frameworks, embrace emerging technologies, and foster knowledge exchange that supports business growth and engineering maturity.

Contact

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Certifications

TOGAF 9.2 Certified

Apr 2021

View Badge

AWS Certified Security - Specialty (SCS)

Oct 2020 – Dec 2023

View Badge

Google Cloud Certified Professional Cloud Architect

Apr 2024 – Apr 2026

View Badge

AWS Certified Solutions Architect - Associate (SAA)

Aug 2023 – Aug 2026

View Badge

Key Achievements

QA Automation & PCI Compliance

Delivered a commander–worker QA automation framework at Coles, achieving PCI compliance and cutting 764 tester-hours annually (~$570K saved).

Operational Efficiency Gains

Eliminated 200 servers of manual deployment through automation, freeing engineers for higher-value delivery.

Cloud Strategy for Computer Vision AI

Transformed a 3-year prototype into a compliant cloud-based Computer Vision AI product at TRU Recognition, delivering first customer deployment and roadmap for scale, cost, and resilience.

Edge & Cloud Hybrid Architecture

Built an edge + SaaS architecture for real-time AI insights with PII compliance, cutting infra/ops costs by ~$972K/year and removing reliance on GPU-heavy data centres.

Identity Platform Transformation

Replaced Auth0 with Google Identity Platform at PaperCut, enabling multi-tenant SaaS scale from thousands to millions of users.

Cost Optimisation at Scale

Redesigned identity architecture, reducing costs from USD 20M/month to USD 30K/month — saving >USD 200M annually.

Established Architecture Practice

Created PaperCut's first architecture practice, setting standards, governance, and mentoring engineers to uplift architectural maturity.

Skills

Leadership

Team, Strategic, Technical, People, Digital transformation, Communication, Problem solving

Architecture

Cloud, Technical, Solution, GCP, AWS, Azure

Engineering

Development, Delivery, DevSecOps, Automation, Finance, Compliance, Identity, Agile

AI

Computer Vision

Environments

Enterprise, Startup

Lead Architect

Papercut

2023 – 2024

- A people-first, outcome-oriented technology leader with a strong focus on continuously optimising cloud product and architecture practices to support the delivery of high-quality, scalable, and reliable SaaS solutions.
- Deep experience in shaping strategic direction, influencing product engineering excellence, and aligning technical initiatives with business growth goals.
- Actively partners with Strategy and Architecture teams to transform technology infrastructure in line with enterprise priorities, delivering tangible business value.
- Provides clear leadership across solution delivery and lifecycle management, overseeing scope, time, cost, people, technology, and vendor relationships to ensure architectural consistency and pragmatic outcomes.
- Drives continuous improvement of customer and user experience by refining cloud architecture strategy across people development, operational processes, and platform health.
- Leads and develops high-performing architecture teams, embedding a DevOps mindset and fostering a culture of innovation, accountability, and technical excellence.
- Champions alignment between architecture and business priorities through effective governance, resource planning, and roadmap execution.
- Communicates organisational vision, values, and strategic objectives with clarity and influence, ensuring stakeholder engagement and cross-functional collaboration.

Senior Engineering Manager

Latitude Financial Services

2022 – 2023

- A people, delivery, and technology leader whose role is to implement and continuously improve Integration engineering practices across the Enterprise ensuring the quality of APIs/App Integration software delivery across planning, execution, and support.
- Develops and manages a high-performing team of 30-40 engineers and architects to build, evolve and maintain APIs/App Integration technology assets.
- Actively collaborates with peers and the Strategy and Architecture team to continue transform Enterprise technology in alignment with Enterprise business growth aspirations.
- Works towards attracting and maintaining the most talented engineering workforce, by creating an empowered, responsible, and outcome driven engineering culture, that contributes back to the industry and Enterprise technology community.
- Support the continuous improvement of the organisations customer experience by defining, executing, and evolving APIs/App Integration engineering strategy across people development, processes improvement and asset health.
- Lead, inspire, manage, and invest in the development and growth of the engineering practices and team members, at the core of the DevOps for APIs/App Integration technology assets.
- Provide overall leadership and governance in shaping (scope, time, cost, people, solutions, and vendors) and executing on solutions and lifecycle management for new and existing projects to pragmatically address business problems and aiming to maintain consistency with domain and architecture strategy.
- Effectively embraces and communicates organisation ambition, core values, strategic direction and key priorities and create strategies and roadmaps that are, well socialised, endorsed and use targeted communications that are appropriate to the varied stakeholders.
- Leads and maintain a governance and reporting structure that aligns initiatives with business priorities while balancing resource constraints to optimise business and technology investments.

Solution Architect

Australia Post

2019 – 2022

- Helped form the future direction, strategy, and key initiatives of Identity Services
- Helped manage relationships with the Senior Leadership and Delivery teams across the organisation
- Managed and liaised with partners including AWS, Salesforce, and others, leveraging their capabilities to rapidly innovate the services for our customers and staff members.
- Key contributor to Identity Services cultural transformation in the Architecture space
- Provided high quality strategic and architectural direction to teams of Identity Services accountable for the delivery of projects, software maintenance and support for Identity Services, Digital iD & TrustCheck platforms.
- Provided technical vision and direction to the Identity Service teams.
- Provided mentorship and coaching to department and delivery team members.
- Built a strong relationship with business and IT stakeholders to implement projects.
- Business Units inside Australia Post include (Identity Services, Digital iD & TrustCheck)
- Developed Governance Artefacts (ABB's, SBB's, Patterns, Principles, Reusable Solutions, SAD's)
- Defined Solution Architecture for common platform capabilities within Portfolio Solutions & Engineering (Complaint Cloud Environment & Developer Portal)
- Delivery Solution Architectures that adhere to compliance regulations including ISM and PCI-DSS and providing the support for Audit's including documentation such as the AADD and interviews

Engineering Lead

Australia Post / Sensis

2017 – 2019

- Helped form the future direction, technical strategy and key initiatives of Identity Services
- Lead the end-to-end delivery in 1 department, multiple squads (~18 people) covering Identity & Security
- Lead the development and growth of our staff, team structures and implemented methodologies, practices, technologies and platforms.
- Key contributor to Identity Services cultural transformation in the Engineering space.
- Provided technical vision and direction to the Identity Services department.
- Ensured the technical capabilities of the development teams were grown to sufficiently deliver on target programs of work.
- Lead IT application delivery capabilities that ensured flexibility, rapid application development practices and shortened time to market.
- Responsible for all stages of the software development lifecycle including all required signoffs and approvals.
- Lead with Servant Leadership while removing blockers and establishing enablers.
- Provided mentorship and coaching to department and delivery team members.
- Managed the core development team and external partners/contractors, which involved business consultation, estimation, planning, end to end accountability for project outcomes and management of the technical team to support and deliver solutions successfully.
- Built a strong relationship with business and IT stakeholders to implement projects.

Software Engineer

Australia Post, Sensis, UXC, O-I, Telstra, Accenture

2005 – 2017

- Can provide additional information on request.

Education

Swinburne University of Technology

Bachelor of Multimedia and Software Development

2002– 2006